

Types of game

Books and films are often grouped by genre or type. Similarly, most computer games fall into a particular class of game. Although there can be a lot of variation within a genre, most games of a particular type will emphasize certain skills, activities, and experiences. Here are some of the most popular gaming genres.



Action

Fast-paced games, where the player has to steer a character or vehicle around obstacles.



Strategy

Games like chess or simulated war games, where logic and planning are required.



Adventure

Games where players explore a fantasy world or setting, solving puzzles and avoiding dangers.



Sports

Games that simulate sports. Some include controllers that mimic sporting equipment.



Party games

Games where several players in the same room compete to win a series of mini-games.



Puzzles

Games where the player has to solve tricky puzzles to advance through the levels.



Role-playing games

Games where the player assumes the identity of a character undertaking a quest or mission.



Simulation

Games that allow players to experience controlling a real-life situation, for example, driving a car.



Targeting

Games where players shoot at targets.



Open world

Games where the player can explore a world and the adventures possible within it.

Computers and consoles

Computer games can be played on normal desktop computers or laptops, but regular gamers often use specialized gaming computers or consoles. The Windows operating system supports the largest number of games. A gaming PC is usually more powerful than general-purpose ones as it has an extra processor to deal with displaying graphics. A games console is a dedicated computer that's only intended for playing games.



IN DEPTH

Early computer games

Early computer games focused on collisions, explosions, and shooting. This was partly because they were relatively easy to code and play. This influenced many earlier controllers, which focused on the ability to shoot and manoeuvre easily.

REAL WORLD

Data collection

Many games collect data about players and send this back to the software companies via the internet. This data can include how long the player is playing for, game scores, and how much money they spend on items in the game. Games can also use controllers to collect data, including biometrics such as weight and facial features. Games played on smartphones can even collect location data.

Custom built

Many serious gamers prefer to build their own gaming computer by putting together the necessary components. This allows them to hand-pick elements such as graphics cards and RAM that suit what they want to use the machine for.